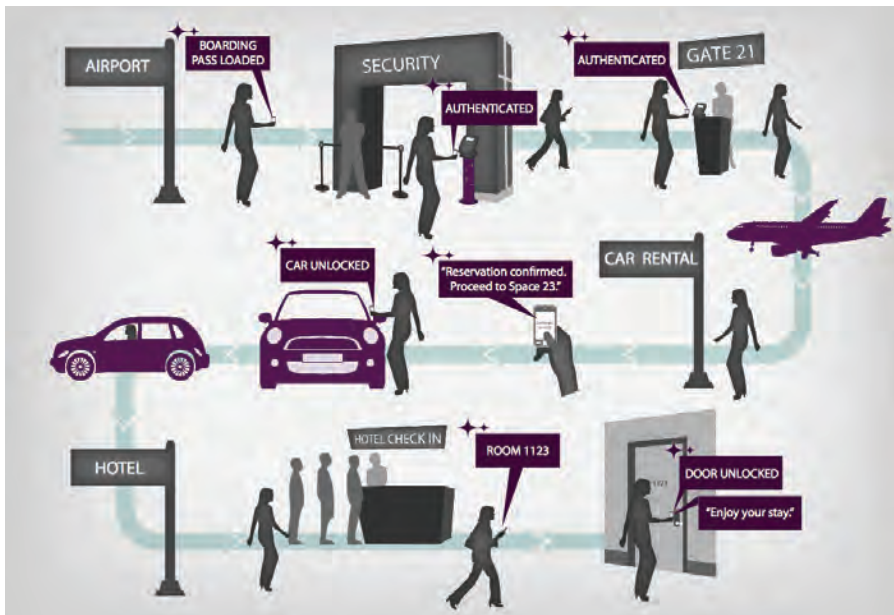


Micromax A85 Superfone drops price

Launched at ₹18,990, the Superfone A85 will now retail for ₹3,700 less, at ₹15,290
<http://bit.ly/uTiY2d>

3G roaming barred

TRAI has asked operators to discontinue the roaming agreements, and threatened to impose hefty penalties <http://bit.ly/ul2tyS>



ISIS' infographic detailing a one-stop NFC-enabled smartphone for ultimate convenience

HOW DOES IT WORK?

NFC isn't exactly rocket science, and we'll stay away from technical details apart from mentioning that NFC is a short-range point-to-point communication standard. In the simplest scenario, you hold an NFC-enabled smartphone next to another NFC-enabled phone or an NFC-enabled payment gateway. If the proximity is close enough, a pop-up registers on both phone's screens (or one, depending on the scenario). You press a key or touch the screen to transfer data to or from the device. Yes, it's that simple.

We experienced the potential of NFC during the launch of Nokia Symbian Belle devices, Nokia 600, 700 and 701. There were NFC-enabled smart posters which allowed you to download movie photos and videos on the Nokia phones if you took them close enough to the posters. Watch the entire video here: <http://bit.ly/nfc098>

APPLICATION SCENARIO

Two prime reasons why NFC is even considered as an independent standard: ease of use and the inherent security it offers. Other existing wireless standards like Wi-Fi 802.11 and Bluetooth are wide-ranged and cumbersome to access, compared to the pure convenience of NFC-enabled devices. There can always be passwords for added protection, but unless the two devices being paired are "in sync" at their respective hardware

level, they'll never touch base and establish communication between each other.

Three key focus areas that will drive the mass adoption of NFC in mobile and consumer electronic devices are retail, transport and accessories. Let's explore them in a bit more detail.

- 1. Retail:** With services like Google Wallet and VISA Wallet, the need to carry a physical credit or debit card in your wallet is kind of negated. Here's how Google Wallet works: you key in your credit card or debit card details in Google Wallet, a cloud service. Then, you download its app on your NFC-enabled smartphone and check for merchants that accept payments through Google Wallet. When you physically checkout of the store, all you do is wave your smartphone near an NFC-enabled cash register and your transaction is reflected on the screen. And that's pretty much it. A task that takes only a couple of seconds.
- 2. Transport:** ISIS, the near field communication mobile wallet venture from Verizon, AT&T and T-Mobile has a very good infographic visually explaining the use of NFC at various stages of a commuter's journey stages. At the airport, you can check in by merely waving your smartphone at the security gate's authentication point, similarly verify and confirm your flight and seat

AVAILABLE NFC-ENABLED SMARTPHONES

- **Samsung:** Galaxy SII, Nexus S, Galaxy Note, Galaxy Nexus and Wave 578
- **HTC:** Amaze 4G
- **Nokia:** C7, 603, 700, 701 and N9
- **BlackBerry:** Bold 9790, 9900 and 9930; Torch 9810 and 9860; Curve 9350, 9360 and 9370

at the final terminal checkpoint. Car rentals can be booked online to get an NFC ticket, which can be used to unlock a pay-per-use car outside the airport. The same phone can finally be used to check into a hotel and even unlock your reserved room! Same principle can be applied to get into a hospital and get healthcare. The possibilities are truly endless, so are the massive benefits.

- 3. Accessories:** As far as personal experiences go, apart from transport and retail applications, NFC-enabled smartphones can pair with supported NFC-enabled headphones, for example, with a simple tap. You can also transfer photos, videos between two NFC-enabled devices by simply bringing them close enough to initiate the data transfer request. During all these NFC "handshakes" between different devices, security and data encryption layers are present to preserve the integrity and safeguard your private data. Let's see, we have our fingers crossed and can only hope NFC generates interest and flies high with consumers. **d**



Virtual wallet services heavily rely on NFC